BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #1 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

# “My body has betrayed me.”

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## Where it often comes from

A diagnosis, a flare, or a body that no longer cooperates can feel like treachery from the one thing we thought we could count on. Anger and grief at the body are natural, and over time they can turn into resentment, fear, or a sense of being at war with ourselves.

## What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” Paul writes, “Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day.” “My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever.” Our bodies live in a fallen world and wear down, but they are still gifts from God and we are still His. You can grieve what has been lost without making your body the enemy.

> *“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well”* (Psalm 139:14).

## Also see

> “Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day” (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> “My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever” (Psalm 73:26).

> “Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God with your body” (1 Corinthians 6:19–20).

> “As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him. For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust” (Psalm 103:13–14).

## Common self-statements

- My body is the enemy.
- It let me down.
- I cannot trust it anymore.
- I am at war with myself.
- It is ruining my life.
- I hate what it has become.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing my body as either perfect or traitor.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my body will keep failing.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling let down and concluding it is hostile.
- Labeling: Calling my body a betrayer.

## Challenging questions

- What did I expect my body to do that it can no longer do?
- What am I grieving?

- What does my body still do for me each day?
- How would I speak to a friend whose body is failing?
- What does Scripture say about the body in a fallen world?
- What would it look like to be gentle with my body?

## Truth summary

> My body is part of a fallen world, yet it is God's gift and I am His. I can grieve my losses, care for my body kindly, and trust God as the strength of my heart.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Suffering
- God, Creator
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Divorce

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "My body has betrayed me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"My body has betrayed me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What did I expect my body to do that it can no longer do?
- ☐ What am I grieving?
- ☐ What does my body still do for me each day?
- ☐ How would I speak to a friend whose body is failing?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the body in a fallen world?
- ☐ What would it look like to be gentle with my body?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ God is the strength of my heart.
- ☐ My body is a gift to steward.
- ☐ Grief is not betrayal.
- ☐ I can be gentle with myself.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  *"I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."*
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."*
- ☐ Psalm 73:26
  *"My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Gentle with my body: Each day, thank God for one thing your body did.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Psalm 139:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am fearfully and wonderfully made, even when my body struggles.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Sickness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] Name the grief. Write what you have lost.
- [ ] Thank your body. List ten things it still does.
- [ ] Follow medical care. Keep appointments and treatment plans.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 73:26. Say it on hard days.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My body has betrayed me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Gentle with my body |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My body has betrayed me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, my body has changed and I am angry and afraid. Teach me to grieve honestly, care for it gently, and rely on You as the strength of my heart. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*